

# Northgate University

## Acceptable Use Policy

*An ISO/IEC 27001:2013 aligned document · Internal Use Only*

|                           |                                    |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>Document Reference</b> | NGU-POL-8.1.3                      |
| <b>Version</b>            | 1.0                                |
| <b>Classification</b>     | Internal Use Only                  |
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| <b>Policy Owner</b>       | Chief Information Security Officer |
| <b>Approved By</b>        | Information Governance Board       |
| <b>Next Review Date</b>   | 01 June 2027                       |
| <b>Aligned Standard</b>   | ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Annex A.8.1.3 |

### 1. Purpose

This policy defines the acceptable use of Northgate University ("the University") information, information systems, devices, networks and accounts. It sets the standards of behaviour expected of all users in order to protect the confidentiality, integrity and availability of University information, in line with ISO/IEC 27001:2013 Annex A.8.1.3.

### 2. Scope

This policy applies to all staff, students, contractors, consultants, partners and any other parties (collectively "users") who access, use or are responsible for University information, IT systems, networks, devices or accounts — whether on University premises or remotely, and whether using University-provided or personal equipment.

### 3. General Principles

- University information and IT resources are provided primarily to support the University's teaching, research, administration and business activities.
- Every user is personally accountable for their use of University information and resources and for activity carried out under their accounts.
- An asset's information classification and handling requirements apply to all use (see Information Classification Policy, NGU-POL-8.2).
- Security controls must not be bypassed, disabled or circumvented.
- Use must comply with applicable law, regulation, licensing terms and University policy.

### 4. Acceptable Use

- Use University information and systems for legitimate University purposes.
- Protect authentication credentials and use multi-factor authentication where required (see Access Control Policy, NGU-POL-9.1).
- Handle information in accordance with its classification.

- Report suspected security incidents, misuse or weaknesses promptly (see Information Security Incident Management Policy, NGU-POL-16.1).
- Reasonable and limited personal use is permitted provided it is lawful, does not interfere with duties, does not consume significant resources, and does not breach this policy.

## 5. Unacceptable Use

The following uses are prohibited. This list is illustrative and not exhaustive:

| Category                                | Examples (non-exhaustive)                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unauthorised access</b>              | Attempting to access systems, data or accounts without authorisation; sharing or using another person's credentials.     |
| <b>Circumventing controls</b>           | Disabling, bypassing or tampering with security controls, anti-malware, logging or monitoring.                           |
| <b>Unauthorised software / services</b> | Installing unlicensed or unauthorised software; using unapproved cloud services to store or process University data.     |
| <b>Illegal or harmful content</b>       | Creating, storing or distributing unlawful, defamatory, discriminatory, harassing or offensive material.                 |
| <b>Data misuse</b>                      | Copying, sharing or removing Confidential information without authorisation; handling personal data contrary to UK GDPR. |
| <b>Resource abuse</b>                   | Excessive personal use that affects performance; cryptomining; using University resources for personal commercial gain.  |
| <b>Misrepresentation</b>                | Sending messages that impersonate others or that misrepresent the views or position of the University.                   |

## 6. Email, Messaging and Communications

- Use University communication systems professionally and lawfully.
- Do not send spam, chain mail, or fraudulent or phishing messages.
- Exercise caution with links and attachments from unknown or unexpected sources.
- Do not automatically forward University email to personal accounts.
- Apply appropriate classification and protection when sending Confidential information (see NGU-POL-8.2).

## 7. Internet and Web Use

- Access the internet from University systems for legitimate purposes; limited reasonable personal use is permitted.
- Do not access, download or distribute unlawful or inappropriate material.
- Web-filtering and monitoring controls may be applied to University networks and managed devices.
- Only obtain software and content from trusted, authorised sources.

## 8. Software, Installation and Intellectual Property

- Only licensed, authorised software may be installed on University systems (A.8.1.3 / A.18.1.2).
- Respect copyright, licensing terms and intellectual property rights.
- Do not copy or distribute software, media or materials in breach of licence or law.

## 9. Use of University Devices and Accounts

- Keep devices physically secure and lock or log off when they are left unattended.
- Do not share accounts or allow others (including family members) to use University devices, accounts or information.
- Keep University-provided devices in their managed, protected configuration; do not remove security controls.
- For remote and mobile working, follow the Remote Working Policy (NGU-POL-6.2).

## 10. Authentication and Credentials

- Keep passwords and authentication information confidential and never share them.
- Use multi-factor authentication where required.
- Choose strong, unique passwords in line with the Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1).

## 11. Data Protection and Privacy

Users must handle personal data lawfully and in accordance with the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018, processing personal and Confidential information only as necessary for authorised University purposes and in line with its classification (A.18.1.4).

## 12. Monitoring

The University may monitor, log and review the use of its information systems and networks for security, operational, legal and compliance purposes. Monitoring is carried out lawfully and proportionately, respecting users' privacy and applicable data protection law.

## 13. Social Media and External Representation

- Where users reference the University, they must do so responsibly and must not disclose Confidential information.
- Personal opinions must not be presented as those of the University.

## 14. Reporting Misuse and Incidents

Users must promptly report suspected misuse, security incidents, lost or stolen devices, and security weaknesses through the University's incident channel so that information and accounts can be protected (see Information Security Incident Management Policy, NGU-POL-16.1).

## 15. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).** Owns this policy and defines acceptable-use standards.
- **Line Managers and Academic Supervisors.** Ensure their staff and students understand and follow this policy.

- **IT Service.** Implements supporting controls (filtering, monitoring, endpoint management) and manages reported misuse.
- **Information Asset Owners (IAOs).** Define any additional acceptable-use requirements for their assets.
- **All users.** Comply with this policy and use University information and resources responsibly.

## 16. Compliance and Enforcement

Compliance with this policy is mandatory. Breaches may result in withdrawal of access and disciplinary action under the relevant staff or student procedures, and, for third parties, may constitute a breach of contract. Unlawful activity may be referred to the relevant authorities.

## 17. Related Policies and Standards

- Information Security Policy (NGU-POL-5.1)
- Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1)
- Information Classification Policy (NGU-POL-8.2)
- Remote Working Policy (NGU-POL-6.2)
- Information Security Incident Management Policy (NGU-POL-16.1)
- ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Annex A.8.1.3; A.8.1.4; A.18.1.2
- UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018

## 18. Document Version History

| Version | Date         | Author                             | Summary of Change                                                                                   |
|---------|--------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0     | 01 June 2026 | Chief Information Security Officer | Initial issue. Establishes acceptable use requirements for University information and IT resources. |